

happy once we have enough money to become FI and retire. All we need to do is put our heads down and get through that decade or two of work to reach the promised land. In the process, we fail to enjoy the journey.

Fortunately, enough people have shared their own version of this story that you can learn without repeating our mistakes. You should enjoy the progressive freedom and power you gain on the path to FI. But this is often easier said than done. Let's look at why people struggle, then explore ideas from the FI community that enable you to enjoy the journey to FI.

In Chapter 2 we briefly introduced Jeff, *The Happy Philosopher*, a physician who was burning out only a few years into his career. Discovering FI was an awakening for him. He was initially under the impression that he needed over ten million dollars to retire. He quickly realized that his personal FI number was a small fraction of this, and with his high salary he could hit his target in about five years. Solving the financial portion of FI was relatively easy for him. But this did not solve his primary problem. He described feeling burned out and dissatisfied with his work and life, and he still had what he described as a “five-year prison sentence” until he could get out. He realized he had to learn to be happy now.